Business Development — your guide

Who this is for: the person who brings brands in, agrees the commercial terms, and hands a signed client over to the account manager. Today that is Aisha.

Your one sentence: you turn an enquiry into a signed brand with clear terms, and you hand it over so cleanly that nobody has to ask you what was promised.

Everything below is a business step. The screen to do it on is in brackets.

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1. Your day, in order

First thing in the morning

1. **Today** (`/work/today`). Your home screen. What is waiting on you.
2. **Partner leads** (`/work/partners`). Every enquiry that came in through the website or the brief form lands here. Nothing should sit here unanswered overnight.
3. **Brands** (`/work/brands`). Every brand you are talking to that is not a client yet.

Through the day

- Work the leads list, not your inbox. An enquiry that only exists in your inbox is invisible to

everyone else and dies when you are on leave.

Before you log off

- Every lead from today has either a reply, a meeting, or a reason it was dropped, written down.

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2. A new enquiry

The steps

1. **Reply the same day.** Short, warm, and with one specific next step: a 15 minute introduction call. Offer two times.

2. **Log the brand** (`/work/brands`). A brand you have logged is not a client yet, and that is fine. It becomes a client when an account is created for them, they pay, or they are sent a quote.
3. **Qualify on the call.** You need six things, and you will not get them later as easily as you get them now:

- What they sell and who they are trying to reach.
- Budget, or at least a range, and per month or per campaign.
- Whether they want paid creators, barter, or both.
- Markets.
- Timing, and whether there is a deadline driving it.
- Who signs, and who pays.

1. **Write the call up the same day**, on the brand record. Three lines is enough. A meeting nobody wrote up did not happen.

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3. Turning interest into a signed deal

The steps

1. **Agree the commercial shape.** Either a rate card and agency fee, or a campaign price. Put it in writing in your own words before you send any document, so there is no surprise in the contract.
2. **Ask talent for a sample list** if the brand wants to see creators before they commit. Give them the brief properly: market, category, budget per creator, deliverables, barter or paid. A vague ask comes back as a vague list.
3. **Send a sample pack or a quote** (`/work/areas?kind=sample` for samples, `/work/proposals` for a priced quote). Never send a spreadsheet you built yourself. The platform's version hides our costs and our margins. Your spreadsheet does not.
4. **Get the paperwork signed.** Agreement, and the purchase order if the client's company needs one before they can pay. Chase the purchase order early. It is the single most common reason a signed deal cannot be invoiced.
5. **Confirm payment terms in writing**: how much up front, how much on completion, and the number of days. "We will sort it out" is not a payment term.

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4. The handover (the step that matters most)

A deal is not done when it is signed. It is done when the account manager can run it without asking you anything.

The steps

1. **Introduce the account manager to the client by email**, and say plainly that they are now the day to day point of contact. Stay on the thread, do not run it.
2. **Hand over in writing**, covering:

- What was sold, in deliverables and numbers of creators.
- The money: total, payment terms, what has been invoiced, what has been received.
- Markets and dates.
- Anything you promised that is not in the contract. All of it. This is the part that burns people.
- The client's contacts and who approves what on their side.

1. **Make sure the client exists in the platform** (`/work/clients`) with the right account, so the account manager has somewhere to run it.
2. After handover, bring anything new the client asks for back to the account manager. Do not accept new scope directly.

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5. Briefs from the client

Often the client sends the creative brief to you. Your job is to pass it on complete, not to summarise it.

A brief must answer all of these before you forward it

1. Timeline, and the last date a post may go live.
2. Objective and the main message.
3. Deliverables per creator, exactly.
4. What the creator receives: cash, barter value, voucher, reimbursement.
5. Market.
6. Content rules: what must appear, what must not, hashtags and tags.
7. Whether the client approves content before it is posted.
8. Whether it applies to paid creators, barter creators, or both.

If the client's brief is missing one, go back and ask. Guessing on behalf of a client is how a campaign gets re-shot.

Then: put it into the campaign in the platform so the whole team reads the same words, and tell the account manager it is there.

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6. Products, vouchers and samples

1. When a client sends vouchers or products for creators, **confirm in writing that we may distribute them** before anybody sends a single one. If the agreement is still being signed, the answer is wait.
2. Record what was received and for which campaign. A box of vouchers nobody logged is a box nobody can account for.

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7. Money, your half of it

1. You agree the price and the terms. Invoices are raised by leadership.
2. You chase the purchase order, and you chase payment after the campaign concludes, politely and on a schedule.
3. **Never discount on the spot.** Any change to agreed pricing goes to leadership first.
4. **Never quote a price for a creator from an internal sheet.** Internal rates are what we pay. The client sees what we charge, and only through a quote.

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8. Rules that do not bend

- **Our cost is never shown to a brand.** Not in a sheet, not in a screenshot, not "just to

show them the maths".

- **Nothing is promised that the team has not confirmed it can deliver.** Especially numbers of

creators and dates.

- **Every verbal promise goes in the handover.** If it is not written down, the person running

the campaign will break it without knowing.

- **A lead with no next step is a lost lead.** Either a date, or a reason it was dropped.

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9. Words we use

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
Lead	An enquiry. Lives in Partner leads until it is a brand.
Brand	Logged, in conversation, not a client yet.
Client	Has an account, or has paid, or has been sent a quote.
Sample pack	A list of example creators, no prices, to show fit.
Quote	The priced list the client opens and picks from.
Purchase order	The client's internal approval that lets them pay us.
Handover	Written transfer of a signed client to the account manager.

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10. If you are stuck

- A client is slow on the purchase order: ask who raises it internally and go to that person.
- Talent's sample list is not right: say exactly what is wrong against the brief, not "the list

is weak".

- A deal needs a price you are not sure about: bring it to leadership before the call, not after.
- You need a decision from leadership and it has been sitting: nudge it from

Decisions (`/work/inbox`). It emails them and they can answer without logging in.

Inside the platform, **Show me how** (top right) runs a guided walkthrough on the real screen, and **Guide** (`/work/guide`) explains what every screen you have is for.